WTF — Kickoff Meeting Minutes

1. Metadata

Title	WTF — Kickoff Meeting
Date (YYYY-MM-DD)	2026-08-11
Duration	1:05:38
Organizer	WTF Click Off Meeting
Location	Virtual
Minutes Author	Agent
Distribution List	TBD
Status	DRAFT — Pending owner assignments

2. Attendance

Present: WTF Podcast Team

Regrets / Absent: None noted

Notetaker / Recorder: Automated transcription service

3. Agenda

- Phase 1 — Performance analytics, AI content search & uncut-version pipeline
- Phase 2 — Content pipeline, transcripts & timestamps (YouTube + uncut modes)
- Phase 3 — Finance, budget tracking, travel requests, CRM & WhatsApp AI agent
- Phase 4 — Guest contracts automation & archival footage integration
- Platform consolidation (WhatsApp / Slack / Notion / Asana → unified OS)
- Research methodology (Snacks → Appetizers → Main course → Desserts)
- Content deliverables, six IPs & episode count planning
- AI-powered abstract & sentimental analysis for clip discovery
- Calendar & color-coded shoot/posting schedule
- Security, access control & server deployment (ZTV cloud + local NAS)
- Domain name procurement

4. Summary

The kickoff meeting established a phased roadmap for building WTF's internal operating system. Phase 1 focuses on unified cross-platform analytics, AI-powered abstract/sentiment-based clip search, and dual-mode transcript ingestion (YouTube + uncut raw clips); Phase 2 on timestamp extraction from clean cuts; Phase 3 on finance automation, CRM integration, and a WhatsApp AI agent; Phase 4 on guest contract workflow automation and archival footage sourcing. The team detailed their four-tier research methodology (Snacks, Appetizers, Main course, Desserts) and confirmed six active IPs including the upcoming OTT-based "Ways of the World." Key infrastructure decisions include using an existing ZTV cloud server, a local E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS, and integrating Asana via API. A color-coded shared calendar and domain name purchase were also requested.

5. Decisions Made

Decision 1: Build a unified OS ("one brain") for WTF

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: Team members are not actively using the current "sauna" system on WhatsApp; switching between multiple platforms (Asana, Slack, Notion, Google Docs/Sheets) creates friction and information loss.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 2: Use clean-cut video files (not published YouTube versions) as the source of truth for transcript extraction and timestamp matching

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: YouTube published versions have ~1 minute offset compared to clean cuts; for 80+ episodes, editors need accurate timestamps from the actual edit files.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 3: Deploy on existing ZTV cloud server + local E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS configuration

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: A cloud server (ZTV) and a local NAS already exist; repurposing them avoids new procurement and maintains data locality.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 4: WhatsApp integration will be read-only to prevent leaks; AI agent will be added to WhatsApp groups for task updates in Phase 3/4

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: Some WhatsApp groups contain confidential guest and internal discussions; read-only protects leaks, while an AI agent can receive tasks and update the OS without exposing sensitive content.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 5: Frame.io (or equivalent) will be the central repository for clean-cut files, with auto-transcription and download options enabled

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: The system already exists but requires manually enabling transcription per video; automation will remove the operational headache.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 6: Phase 1 will support two transcript modes: YouTube mode + uncut version mode

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: Raw uncut clips contain animation cues and complete context that published YouTube versions lack; feeding both into the AI model improves timestamp accuracy and content discovery.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 7: Research methodology will follow four-tier structure: Snacks → Appetizers → Main course → Desserts

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: This structured approach ensures depth (guest personality, industry GDP impact, exact industry positioning, future takeaways) and leverages offline VC/CEO research for credibility.

Effective date: TBD

Decision 8: CRM integration will be built in Phase 3/4 to track leads and potential guests

Who decided / approved: Team consensus

Rationale: Guest leads currently come from website, email, LinkedIn, and WhatsApp; centralizing them in the OS with AI memory enables proper pipeline management.

Effective date: TBD

6. Action Items

[A1] Share analytics format document / template with the development team

Owner: WTF team lead

Due: ASAP

Acceptance Criteria: Document showing current analytics format across all channels delivered to the dev team

[A2] Provide API access to all platforms (YouTube, TikTok, etc.)

Owner: Tech/ops lead

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: API keys or access credentials shared; platform connections verified

[A3] Set up automated internal reporting for weekly/monthly content performance

Owner: Dev team

Due: Phase 1 completion

Acceptance Criteria: Automated reports generating cross-platform insights and record-breaking alerts

[A4] Investigate and resolve Hindi analytics tracking (separate channel vs. auto-dubbing)

Owner: TBD

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: Clear method to measure Hindi-specific viewership

[A5] Transfer Slack information to the new OS manually

Owner: TBD

Due: Before Phase 3

Acceptance Criteria: All relevant Slack data migrated and accessible in the new system

[A6] Build finance/budget tracker with graphical representation and auto-trigger to finance team

Owner: Dev team

Due: Phase 3

Acceptance Criteria: Google Sheets-like interface with AI voice input, automatic budget updates, and scheduled delivery

[A7] Map and automate guest contract workflow (current email-heavy process)

Owner: Dev team

Due: Phase 4

Acceptance Criteria: Step-by-step guest contract automation documented and implemented

[A8] Train AI module for abstract concept recognition and sentimental analysis beyond keyword search

Owner: Dev/AI lead

Due: Phase 1

Acceptance Criteria: AI can identify timestamps for abstract topics (e.g., trauma, philosophy) and emotional/sentimental moments without exact keyword matches

[A9] Evaluate Frame.io licensing and enable auto-transcription for all videos

Owner: TBD

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: Decision on purchase/transfer; auto-transcription enabled

[A10] Deliver 19 episodes on primary channel + 5 episodes on secondary channel

Owner: Content/editorial team

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: Episode count verified; deliverables aligned with content calendar

[A11] Set up ES (Instagram wheel/reel format) content pipeline

Owner: Content team

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: Wheel-format content created and scheduled for Instagram

[A12] Research and integrate archival/stock footage source for montage/transition clips

Owner: TBD

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: At least one archival footage source identified and integrated

[A13] Verify Asana API access and pull existing projects/tasks into WTF OS

Owner: Tech/ops lead

Due: Phase 1

Acceptance Criteria: Asana API key confirmed; project data successfully synced to unified platform

[A14] Integrate existing ZTV cloud server + E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y local NAS as backend infrastructure

Owner: Dev/infra lead

Due: Phase 1

Acceptance Criteria: Both servers accessible, documented, and connected to the OS

[A15] Implement dual-mode transcript pipeline (YouTube mode + uncut version mode)

Owner: Dev/AI lead

Due: Phase 1

Acceptance Criteria: Both raw clips and published YouTube videos ingestable; timestamps match clean cuts accurately

[A16] Build color-coded shared calendar for shoots, posting schedules, and team visibility

Owner: Dev team

Due: Phase 2

Acceptance Criteria: Calendar editable by team; color coding for shoot start, posting time, and milestones

[A17] Integrate CRM module for guest leads and pipeline tracking

Owner: Dev team

Due: Phase 3/4

Acceptance Criteria: All inbound guest leads from website/email/LinkedIn/WhatsApp captured and trackable

[A18] Deploy WhatsApp AI agent for task assignment and OS updates

Owner: Dev team

Due: Phase 3/4

Acceptance Criteria: Team can assign tasks to AI agent in WhatsApp; agent updates WTF OS automatically

[A19] Enable AI-powered clip discovery across YouTube, Instagram, and archival footage

Owner: Dev/AI lead

Due: Phase 1/2

Acceptance Criteria: Editor can search by topic and receive relevant clip suggestions from all three sources

[A20] Procure domain name for WTF OS

Owner: Ops lead

Due: TBD

Acceptance Criteria: Domain purchased and configured for platform hosting

7. Notes by Agenda Item

Agenda Item 1: Phase 1 — Performance Analytics, AI Search & Dual-Mode Pipeline

Key points:

- Need cross-platform analytics (YouTube, TikTok, Instagram) with automated internal reporting
- Currently only YouTube analytics are available; TikTok and shorts data need to be figured out
- AI-driven insights: break records, monthly summaries, anomaly detection
- Cost per acquisition model discussed: ~10 per subscriber when spending 5 floors for 5 billion subscribers
- Need to connect performance data to finance to justify spend

- Phase 1 will support TWO transcript modes: (a) YouTube mode (published version), (b) Uncut version mode (raw clips)
- Uncut mode feeds raw clips to AI to save complete data; timestamps and transcripts pulled from animation cues
- AI must support abstract concept recognition (e.g., trauma, philosophy) beyond exact keywords
- Sentimental analysis required: AI identifies emotional moments (friends, family, heartfelt topics) for clip discovery
- Reference model: Johnny Harris-style montage creation using AI-found clips

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: How to track Hindi content separately? Separate channel vs. YouTube auto-dubbing?
- Q2: TikTok API access uncertain — team to check and revert
- Q3: Can AI find clips across YouTube, Instagram, and archival footage based on specific topics?

Agenda Item 2: Phase 2 — Content Pipeline, Transcripts & Timestamps

Key points:

- Current process: YouTube video → transcript extraction → LLM processing → timestamps on sheet
- Problem: Timestamps from published YouTube version don't match clean cuts (~1 minute offset)
- Decision: Use clean-cut files as source of truth for timestamp extraction
- Frame.io already has transcript export and timestamped download capabilities
- Problem with Frame.io: auto-transcription must be manually enabled per video
- For first ~15 older episodes, clean cuts don't exist; will need manual offset adjustment (~5–7 seconds)
- Editors should use Frame.io source files for all shorts/clips, not YouTube published versions
- YouTube remains public access only; internal workflow uses Frame.io clean cuts

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Who will purchase/own the Frame.io license?
- Q2: How to handle episodes without clean cuts / matching transcripts?
- Q3: Can a master sheet be maintained with both Frame.io and YouTube timestamps for editor reference?

Agenda Item 3: Phase 3 — Finance, Budget, CRM & WhatsApp AI Agent

Key points:

- Current process: Manual WhatsApp updates, Google Sheets for budget tracking
- Goal: AI-powered budget tracker with voice input, graphical representation, and auto-send to finance team
- Need to understand current approval processes for travel, shoots, events
- Monthly budget tracking with cost-vs-reward per initiative (animation, stage, etc.)
- CRM integration planned: all guest leads and potential guests to be captured and updated in OS
- WhatsApp AI agent: team can give tasks to the agent in WhatsApp groups; agent updates WTF OS automatically

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Current finance team contact details and approval chain need to be documented
- Q2: CRM fields and guest pipeline stages need to be defined
- Q3: WhatsApp agent access level — read-only vs. write access to OS?

Agenda Item 4: Phase 4 — Guest Contracts & Archival Footage

Key points:

- Current process is entirely email-based and scattered
- Need step-by-step automation: guest expression of interest → research team contact → contract → logistics
- High volume of inbound guest requests via website, LinkedIn, email
- Goal: Segregate and manage guest requests within the OS with AI memory layer
- Archival footage integration: need sources for transition stories and montages (two websites exist but expensive)
- Goal: Integrated access within OS for relevant archival/stock content

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Team needs to walk through the exact guest contract steps for automation mapping
- Q2: Budget and source for archival footage to be confirmed

Agenda Item 5: Platform Consolidation (Asana, Slack, Notion, WhatsApp, Google Docs/Sheets → unified OS)

Key points:

- Team currently uses multiple platforms: Asana, Slack, Notion, WhatsApp, Google Docs/Sheets
- "Sauna" on WhatsApp is underutilized — team members don't actively use it
- Goal: One OS that replaces scattered tools and consolidates all workflows
- Asana API key needs to be verified so existing projects/tasks can be pulled into WTF OS
- WhatsApp integration will be read-only for security; AI agent added for task updates
- Server deployment: existing ZTV cloud server + local E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS configuration

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Which specific Slack channels/information need migration?
- Q2: Asana API key status — does it exist and what scopes are granted?

Agenda Item 6: Research Methodology — Snacks, Appetizers, Main Course, Desserts

Key points:

- Snacks: Individual guest personality and expanded personality profile
- Appetizers: Core industry analysis, percentage of GDP impact, comparison to similar industries
- Main course: Exact industry positioning and what can be built in that industry for a 20–24-year-old in India
- Desserts: Biggest takeaway + future direction of the industry
- Offline research heavily relied upon: interviews with CEOs, entrepreneurs, and VCs of the target industry
- Research questions: How much money do they put in? Why do they put it in?
- Overall research time per podcast episode: approximately one week

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Can the AI module help automate parts of this research (industry GDP data, comparable industries)?
- Q2: How should research outputs be stored and made searchable in the OS?

Agenda Item 7: Content Deliverables, Six IPs & Episode Planning

Key points:

- Target: 19 episodes on primary channel + 5 episodes on secondary channel
- Also: ES (Instagram wheel format), shorts, clips
- Content buckets tracked: M1 (main episode), S1 (short), S2 (small post), ES (wheel)

- Old episodes (~80+) need retroactive processing for timestamps
- Six current IPs: (1) Nitya Kamat, (2) BTS, (3) POV, (4) Animation, (5) Stitched, (6) Ways of the World
- Ways of the World is an OTT-based IP launching soon in Phase 1
- Each IP tracked separately on calendar with budget/spend attribution

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Dependency on secondary UI — if not ready, primary channel gets full load
- Q2: Launch timeline for "Ways of the World" OTT IP to be confirmed

Agenda Item 8: AI Content Search — Abstract & Sentimental Analysis

Key points:

- Current keyword search works for specific terms (e.g., "health") but fails for abstract concepts (e.g., "trauma," "philosophy")
- AI module needs training on sentiment analysis and abstract topic recognition
- Use case: Finding clips for montage stories (e.g., travel episode transitions)
- Sentimental analysis: AI identifies emotional moments (friends, family, heartfelt topics) for clip extraction
- Reference: Johnny Harris-style storytelling using AI-discovered clips

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Need more examples from content team to train the model
- Q2: Can AI search across Instagram, YouTube, and archival footage simultaneously?

Agenda Item 9: Calendar & Color-Coded Schedule

Key points:

- Team needs a shared calendar visible to entire WTF team
- Color coding required: shoot start dates, posting times, milestones
- Calendar must be editable by team members
- Goal: Full visibility of what needs to be done and when

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Calendar platform preference — built into OS or integrate Google/Outlook calendar?

Agenda Item 10: Security, Access Control & Server Infrastructure

Key points:

- WhatsApp integration must be read-only to prevent leaks
- Role-based access: admin, user, owner tiers
- Dedicated server for WTF; no shared hosting
- Cloud server: ZTV (existing, to be repurposed)
- Local server: E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS configuration (existing, to be integrated)

Agenda Item 11: Domain Name Procurement

Key points:

- Need to purchase a domain name for WTF OS
- Domain will serve as the public-facing URL for the unified platform

Open issues / questions:

- Q1: Preferred domain name(s) to be confirmed by team

8. Parking Lot / Unresolved Items

TikTok API access and analytics integration

Why parked / next step: Team member to check feasibility and revert with API details

Suggested owner: Tech/ops lead

Hindi content analytics strategy (separate channel vs. auto-dubbing)

Why parked / next step: Need to test whether YouTube auto-dubbing provides granular analytics; otherwise maintain separate channel

Suggested owner: Content lead

Frame.io license ownership and procurement

Why parked / next step: Decision on who buys/licenses the account; currently under one team member's account

Suggested owner: Finance/ops lead

Exact guest contract process mapping

Why parked / next step: Team needs to document the full email-based workflow before automation

Suggested owner: Production/operations lead

Archival footage source and budget

Why parked / next step: Identify specific websites and cost per clip; integrate into OS

Suggested owner: Content lead

Asana API key verification

Why parked / next step: Confirm if API key exists and what data scopes are accessible

Suggested owner: Tech/ops lead

ZTV server access credentials & E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS configuration docs

Why parked / next step: Need login details and network setup documentation

Suggested owner: Dev/infra lead

Domain name selection and purchase

Why parked / next step: Team to shortlist preferred domains and approve purchase

Suggested owner: Ops lead

9. Risks / Blockers

Timestamps from older episodes (first ~15) don't have clean cuts, requiring manual offset work

Impact: Delay in Phase 2 rollout; editor overhead

Mitigation owner: TBD

TikTok API may not be accessible; analytics for TikTok content would remain manual

Impact: Incomplete cross-platform reporting in Phase 1

Mitigation owner: TBD

WhatsApp read-only integration may not capture enough context if team members don't actively use the platform

Impact: OS becomes a passive archive rather than active workflow hub

Mitigation owner: TBD

Frame.io manual transcription toggle creates operational friction at scale (80+ episodes)

Impact: Editors still doing repetitive work; automation value reduced

Mitigation owner: TBD

Asana API key missing or insufficient scopes

Impact: Cannot pull existing project data into WTF OS; manual migration required

Mitigation owner: Tech/ops lead

ZTV cloud server or E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS access issues

Impact: Infrastructure unavailability delays Phase 1 deployment

Mitigation owner: Dev/infra lead

AI abstract/sentiment analysis accuracy insufficient for production use

Impact: Editors cannot rely on AI-discovered clips; manual search still needed

Mitigation owner: Dev/AI lead

10. Next Meeting / Follow-up

Proposed date/time: TBD

Objectives for next meeting:

1. Confirm API access status for all platforms (YouTube, TikTok, Asana)
2. Verify Asana API key and review existing project structure
3. Review current finance/budget process documentation
4. Walk through guest contract email workflow
5. Finalize Frame.io licensing decision
6. Test AI abstract concept and sentiment recognition on sample episodes
7. Confirm ZTV server + E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y NAS access and credentials
8. Shortlist and approve domain name for WTF OS
9. Define CRM fields and guest pipeline stages

11. Attachments / References

Agenda document: TBD

Slides: TBD

Transcript / Recording: WTF_Kickoff_Meeting_Transcript.docx

Research methodology reference: Johnny Harris-style montage / clip discovery

Related tickets: TBD

12. Version & Change Log

Version: 1.1 (Draft)

Last updated: 2026-08-12T14:17:12Z

Changes: v1.0 initial draft from transcript. v1.1 added research methodology (Snacks/Appetizers/Main course/Desserts), six IPs, dual-mode transcript pipeline (YouTube + uncut), Asana integration, ZTV/E-Y-S-C-O-T-O-L-G-Y server details, CRM & WhatsApp AI agent, calendar & color coding, sentimental analysis, archival footage clip search, and domain name procurement.

DRAFT — Pending from organizer: Action item owner assignments. All other metadata confirmed.